

**APRIL 2005**

# T L DIRECT

## The Line Direct

### REACHING NEW HEIGHTS !

This motto, that TLD elected several years ago, clearly shows us the way.

Year after year, in a moving environment, and whatever the trends of the currencies, the prices of raw material, and the difficulties of the air transport sector, we set ourselves new goals, as mountaineers undertake to climb a new top.

Our own goals are :

- the continuous improvement of the quality of our products
- a stronger support to our customers, in his extent and its quality
- a better efficiency of our working methods, which drives our economic performance
- the development of the equipment of the future.

To achieve these goals, like in mountaineering we are all tied to the same rope, which means that we all depend on the efforts of the others.

In 2004, after 3 difficult years, our Group has been profitable, thanks to the efforts and contribution of every one. This is a symbolic milestone, but our ambition is beyond that. We aim at making TLD a reference, if not The reference, in the GSE industry.

As we progress, new challenges appear, but to a valiant Team, nothing is impossible !

In order to better show the dynamism of our Team, which is steadily strengthened by the addition of new talents, TLDirect now includes a new heading : TLD People.

I wish you a good reading!

Jean-Marie Fulconis

## The Latest Dispatch

### Boeing Awards contract to TLD for giant cargo loaders

In a world of increasing fuel prices and struggling airline companies, Boeing has set out to create the next generation passenger Airplane initially introduced as the 7E7 for it's projected fuel economy. It has finally been named the B-787.

The B-787 introduces a great departure from the traditional method of building airplanes out of aluminum by introducing a higher content of composite material than ever before in commercial aviation.

To mitigate the development risk as well as capital investment, Boeing in another departure from their traditional manufacturing techniques have turned to outsourcing to worldwide partners to contribute to the design and manufacturing of the 787 components.

The Boeing company in order to move the components of the 787 between manufacturing plants has decided to follow a method pioneered by their rivals at Airbus.

B-747-400 airplanes will be modified to have larger fuselage diameter as well as added length to be able to transport the fuselage and various sections of the 787 within. This new airplane now called the B-747-LCF (Large Cargo Freighter) was created.



Boeing has trusted TLD with the design and manufacture of the biggest and most capable Loader Transporter ever to be created, 110 ft long with a 150,000 lbs capacity, capable of speed of up to 10 mph. A special team was created in TLD Canada at Sherbrooke to handle the task of creating and producing the DBL-110.

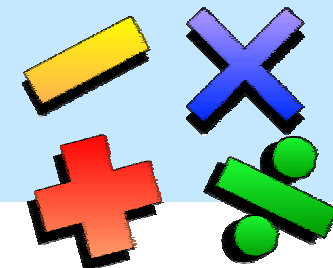
Fadi Anboub

## The Latest Dashboard

### T L Dash board (in M€uros)

(Year to date-end of DECEMBER figures)

| TLD Sales                                                                  | 2004/12      |                  | 2004/2003<br>% Evolution |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------|------------------|--------------------------|
|                                                                            | in M€uros    | in %<br>of total |                          |
| <b>GSE - AREA AMERICA</b><br>(Americas, Australia, Japan, N. Zealand)      | 30,7         | 28,2%            | 22,5%                    |
| <b>GSE - AREA EUROPE</b><br>(Europe, Africa, middle east, India, Pakistan) | 40,1         | 36,9%            | 14,5%                    |
| <b>GSE - AREA ASIA</b><br>(w/o Taiw an TRVD)                               | 16,6         | 15,3%            | 37,6%                    |
| <b>Other activities</b><br>(Adhésives solutions + Taiw an TRVD)            | 21,3         | 19,6%            | 55,4%                    |
| <b>TOTAL TLD SALES</b>                                                     | <b>108,6</b> | <b>100%</b>      | <b>26,6%</b>             |



## TLD Life Digest

### Indian Aviation takes off

INDIA has always been an important market for TLD EUROPE but it is necessary to point out that the Indian aviation sector is now really moving ahead in many ways.

First of all the Indian private airlines are now allowed to operate in any part of the globe provided they have a minimum of 5 years experience and a fleet of minimum 20 aircrafts. Secondly, the two major airports of the country (DELHI & MUMBAI) are now under major modernisation program and the Airports Authority of India is currently starting bringing 25 other airports to a world standard. Lastly low cost airlines now extend service all over the country.

The Civil Aviation Ministry is currently looking at increasing the Aircraft fleet from 175 to approximately 220. The approximate Civilian Aircraft fleet of Airlines in India is as follows:

- Current AIR INDIA Fleet of 35 Aircraft will be increased after acquisition of 50 Aircraft, which will be a combination of B777 and A340. In addition, Air India will charter 18 Boeing 737-800 on Order
- INDIAN AIRLINES : 62 avions (A320)
- JET AIRWAYS – 42 aircraft : combination of Boeing 737-900, 737-800, 737-700, 737-400
- AIR SAHARA : 20 aircraft : Embraer and B737
- KINGFISHER AIRLINES : 8 "A320" will be delivered in 2005 to this brand new low cost airline and 8 more being delivered in 2006. By year 2008 Kingfisher Airlines will have a total of 34 aircraft.

- AIR DECCAN : 6 A320s. Air Deccan is planning for acquisition of 30 more A320s with Airbus.
- ROYAL AIRWAYS has signed an agreement to lease a first set of 3 Boeing 737-800s and signed a Contract for 10 B737-800s at the recent Bangalore Air Show.
- GO AIRLINES : DGCA have cleared them to start operations Fleet Plans mostly for A320s
- INDUS AVIATION is planning to acquire 50 Seater RJ-145 Aircraft

All these aircraft acquisition will generate a lot of ground support equipment requirements, and TLD should be the major supplier. Currently TLD has more than 250 units in operation within the country, from conveyor belts to TPX350. Some of those units are more than 15 years old, and yet still maintained in a good running condition, with the help and support of our business and service partner MILLENIUM AERODYNAMICS presided by Mr Milan Zatakia.

TLD has equipment with AIR INDIA, INDIAN AIRLINES, JET AIRWAYS, INTERGLOBE, CAMBATA, KINGFISHER and hopefully the list will continue to grow with new comers like AIR DECCAN, AIR SAHARA and ROYAL AIRWAYS.

The Civil Aviation Minister Mr. Praful Patel has declared the year 2005 as an "Airport Year", but we should also call it the "TLD Year", as the prospect for our growth in India in 2005 looks clearly bright.

Christophe Lesbaudy

## TLD Life Digest

### TLD on the European market

In spite of a very important local competition and the difficult economic situation of these last years, TLD has been able to increase its position on the European market.

According to our European customers, TLD has now a very complete line of products, well adapted to the market, and offering a good price to quality ratio.

This results from our continuous presence (and listening capacity) close to our customers, even during the most difficult period in our industry.

It is remarkable that, having earned market shares during these last two years, either via new customers, or via the sales of new products of the TLD range to existing customers, TLD did also not lose any of its customers.

To name only a few well-known customers, among whom TLD recently progressed : Alfa catering, Ineuropa , Kiss , Malev (Hungaria National Airline) , Menzies , Ryanair , Swissport... We still have a lot to accomplish : TLD presence on certain markets like Germany, Italy, Austria is still weak.

Whereas the quality and the technology of our 828 and 929 loaders is undisputable, the sales of such equipment suffers from high freight charges from Canada to Europe.

Lastly, TLD good position with the handling companies should be considered as a very positive point, allowing us to be optimistic for the future. It is indeed a growing market for the coming years, and the multiplicity of their operation sites constitutes an excellent promotion for our products.

Alain Porcheron

## The Last Development of TLD Saint-Lin

Among the large family of baggage tractors manufactured by TLD Europe in Saint-Lin facility, THX and TEX have enjoyed recent and significant features improvements.

THX stands for hydrostatic transmission. Not the most well-known among the baggage tractor, but one of the most exciting. With its very compact design, THX offer a very good manoeuvrability in airport and industrial environments. Customers appreciate its autonomy and the very smooth acceleration. Air France has been since the beginning a regular customer of THX tractor and represents a important reference. Standard draw bar pull is 2000 daN (or 4500 lbs) for the THX. THX are now equipped with reinforced cab floor and industrial tyres.



Electrical baggage tractors TEX are more and more popular. Silence, smooth acceleration and manoeuvrability are some of the main advantages of TEX. TEX is the best choice for customers who look after better working conditions for their employees and who require environment friendly products.

In addition TEX offer the most competitive operating cost compared to other baggage tractor technologies and requires simplified maintenance. TEX offers 1800 daN (4000lbs) as a standard and 2250 daN (5000lbs) as an option.

Saint-Lin has recently brought a couple of modifications in order to increase TEX reliability : reinforced cab floor, stronger spring leaves, industrial tyres as a standard, redesign of electro-pump environment, more reliable hand brake and protection of the electrical motor against water ingress.



A manufacturing line has been dedicated to TEX and THX tractors which allow better productivity and quality consistency.

Yves de Veyrac

## The Last Development of TLD Shanghai

### Challenging year of Rooster for TLD SHA.

Our plant is currently focusing on deep re-structuring, to improve its efficiency and increase its capacity, in order to face continuous increasing orders especially those for export.

Unfortunately, one event has just occurred, which has very negative impact compromising our efforts: due to undetermined reasons (still under investigation), we found that our Office Building inclines too important, and is measured and considered as Dangerous Building by Governmental Building Quality Control Bureau.

As a member of Safety focused group, with the help of our head office, decisions are made immediately, and emergency evacuation plan is established:

1. Temporary Collective Office Facility to be built for Engineering, Production, Purchasing, Quality staffs.
2. Ex-storage and after service rooms to be requisitioned for Plant Management, Administration and Finance.
3. Office to be rent for Chine Eastern Regional Sales Office.
4. A new Office Building to be built, this year.

By the end of March, item 1 and 2 has been accomplished (see illustrating pictures). Authorization of new office has been delivered by local government, and its detail design is on going. We are confident that SHA staff will overcome above mentioned difficulties, and will keep their promised for the year end result.

Tang Xiang



## TLD people

### A new Area Sales Managers in the TLD EUROPE Sales Team

We are happy to announce the arrival of **Mr Christoph PORTELE** within the TLD EUROPE Sales Team.

Christoph will be Area Sales Manager for the following countries : Austria, Bosnia, Bulgaria, Croatia, Ex Yugoslavia, Germany; Hungary, Macedonia; Moldavia, Romania, Serbia, Slovakia Republic, Slovenia, Switzerland, Armenia and will also follow customers like FEDEX, DHL and SWISSPORT.



Christoph is 33 years old and is German. He speaks English fluently.

He previously worked with Lufthansa LEOS as Worldwide Sales Manager for Aircraft Tooling, after working as Project Engineer for Ground Support Equipment (Passenger steps and Conveyor Belts).

Christoph will be based in Frankfurt, where he lives – His e-mail address is : [cportele@tld-europe.com](mailto:cportele@tld-europe.com)

He will join us on April 4 and will start by visiting our TLD plants for his integration period.

We wish him Welcome, a lot of success in his new functions, and assure him of the support of the whole TLD team